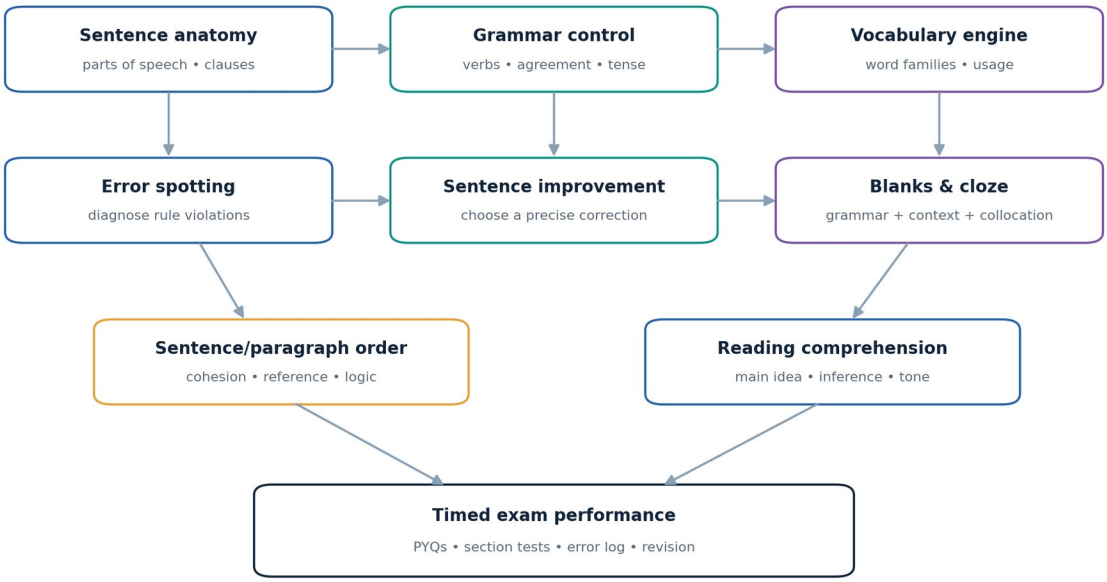
SSC CGL

ENGLISH LANGUAGE & COMPREHENSION

MASTER SYLLABUS • TIER-I + TIER-II • 24-WEEK EXECUTION PLAN

A priority-led system for grammar, vocabulary, reading, question practice and exam speed.

Learning dependency: build language control, then combine skills



THE CORE IDEA

Do not study English as disconnected chapters. Build the grammar engine, grow vocabulary daily, practise comprehension in context, then convert every skill into fast and accurate exam performance.

Inside: official syllabus map • historical topic chart • priority framework • grammar and vocabulary checklists • reading strategy • 24-week roadmap • daily practice plan • mastery tracker.

Evidence base: official SSC CGL 2026 notification plus third-party topic-tag analysis of papers from 2019–2025. Historical frequency guides practice; it does not guarantee future weightage.

Prepared: 30 October 2026 | Use the current SSC notification as the final authority.

1. Know the exam before choosing the syllabus

The English section is important in both stages. Tier-I tests broad, fast recognition across vocabulary, grammar and comprehension. Tier-II gives English more marks and more time, and explicitly describes the comprehension component in greater detail.

Exam stage	Question count	Marks	Time	Wrong-answer penalty
Tier-I: English Comprehension	25	50	15 minutes	−0.50 mark
Tier-II Paper-I: English Language & Comprehension	45	135	40 minutes	−1 mark

IMPORTANT TIER-II DETAIL

The official 2026 notification says the Tier-II English section tests vocabulary, grammar, sentence structure, synonyms/homonyms, antonyms, spellings, idioms, one-word substitution, sentence improvement, voice, narration, rearrangement, cloze and comprehension. It specifies three or more comprehension paragraphs, including at least one simple book/story passage and two current-affairs passages based on a report or editorial.

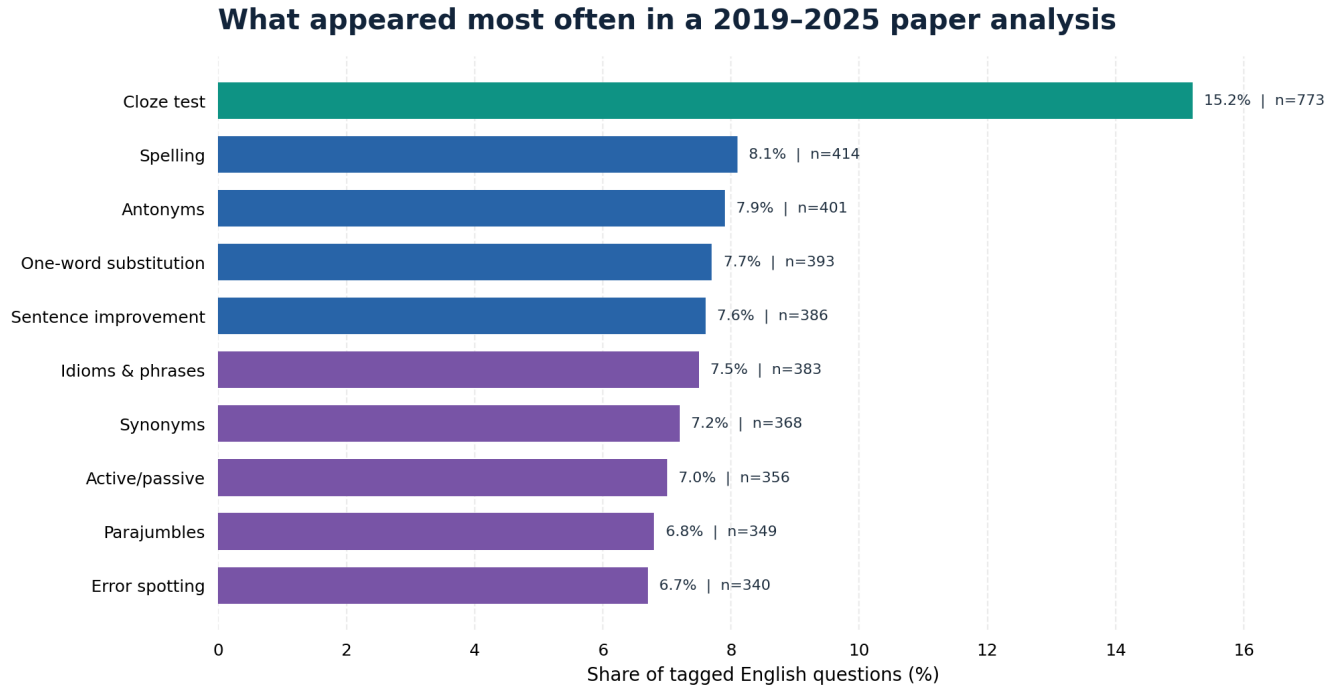
What changes from Tier-I to Tier-II?

Skill	Tier-I emphasis	Tier-II emphasis
Vocabulary	Quick recognition and correct contextual use	Broader word knowledge; less time per mark, so accuracy matters
Grammar	Fast error detection and correction	Precise grammar under higher negative marking
Comprehension	Quick main idea, detail and inference	More sustained reading; several paragraph types are described in the notice
Execution	25 questions in 15 minutes	45 questions in 40 minutes; 3 marks each

Official source: SSC CGL 2026 Notice of Examination, sections 13.8, 13.9 and 13.11.3. Check the notice for the cycle you actually sit.

2. What historical English papers actually emphasise

A third-party analysis reports 5,101 topic-tagged English questions from 204 SSC CGL papers from 2019 to 2025. Its counts are helpful for prioritisation, but SSC does not publish an official fixed weightage. Topic labels can also vary by archive.



Source: Comperly Acad tagged-question analysis; 5,101 English items from 204 papers, 2019–2025. Third-party categorisation, not SSC-published weightage.

Three useful conclusions

- Cloze Test is the largest single tag in this dataset: 773 items, 15.2% of the tagged English section.
- The vocabulary cluster (spelling + antonyms + one-word substitution + idioms + synonyms) totals 1,959 items, about 38.4% of tagged English questions in this dataset. Treat this as a powerful reason for daily vocabulary, not as a forecast for the next paper.
- The next topics are spread fairly closely from 6.7% to 8.1%. Do not over-specialise in just one grammar rule or vocabulary list.

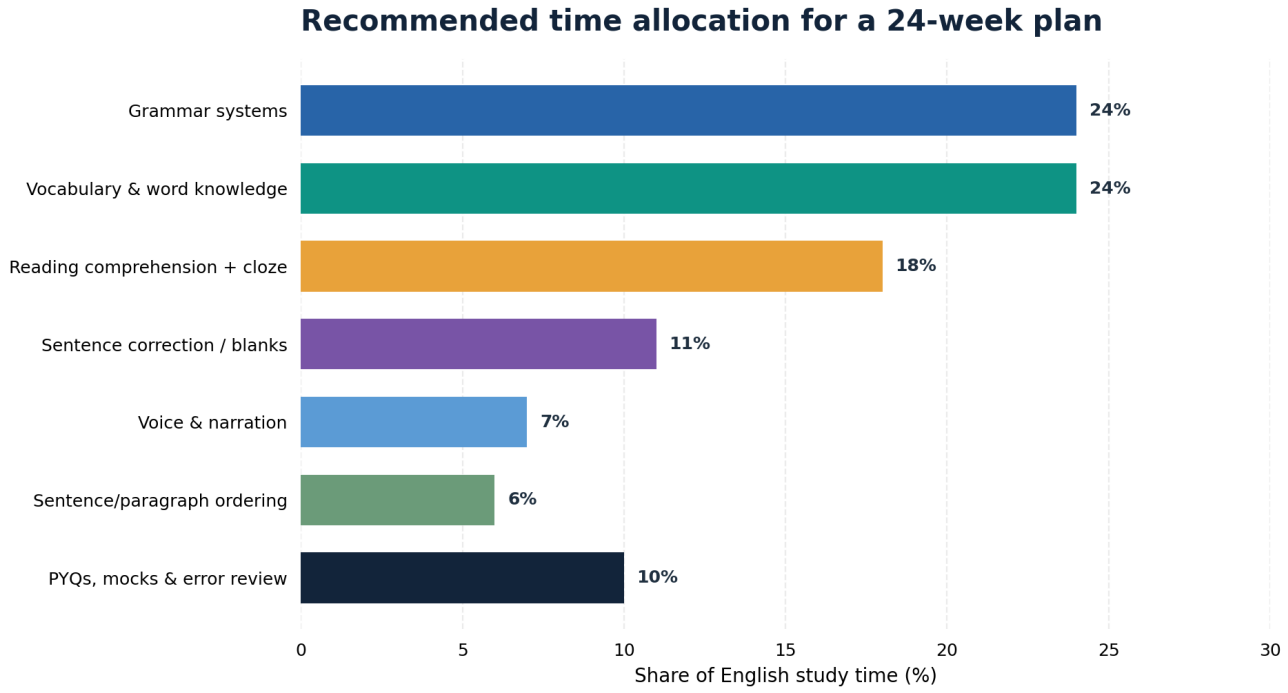
HOW TO USE FREQUENCY

Use the chart to decide what receives early and repeated practice. Use the official notification to decide what belongs in the syllabus. Never skip a listed topic because a historical tag appears small.

3. The priority system: learn high transfer skills first

Instead of following a textbook page by page, organise English into skill engines. A good grammar rule improves error spotting, sentence improvement, fill-in-the-blanks, cloze and even comprehension. A word learned with collocations helps vocabulary and passage interpretation together.

Priority	What goes here	Why it is placed here	Completion rule
P0 — Grammar engine	Sentence parts, subject–verb agreement, verbs/tenses, pronouns, articles/determiners, prepositions, conjunctions, clauses	Core grammar errors and correction questions depend on these rules	Explain the rule; solve fresh items without notes
P1 — High-return practice	Cloze; synonyms; antonyms; spelling; one-word substitution; idioms/phrases; sentence improvement; error spotting	These occupy the most visible recurring historical tags, and vocabulary skills transfer across question types	Use mixed sets and spaced revision
P1 — Comprehension engine	Reading comprehension, main idea, detail, inference, tone, contextual vocabulary, cloze logic	Builds accuracy across both passage-based formats	Read new passages under time
P2 — Sentence transformation	Active/passive, direct/indirect narration, sentence-part shuffling, sentence arrangement	Rule based, learnable, and explicitly listed in Tier-II syllabus	Use transformation tables + PYQs
P3 — Finish and polish	Homonyms, confusing words, collocations, phrasal verbs, paragraph coherence, rare grammar edge cases from PYQs	Improves completeness after core skills are stable	Add topics found in actual PYQ review

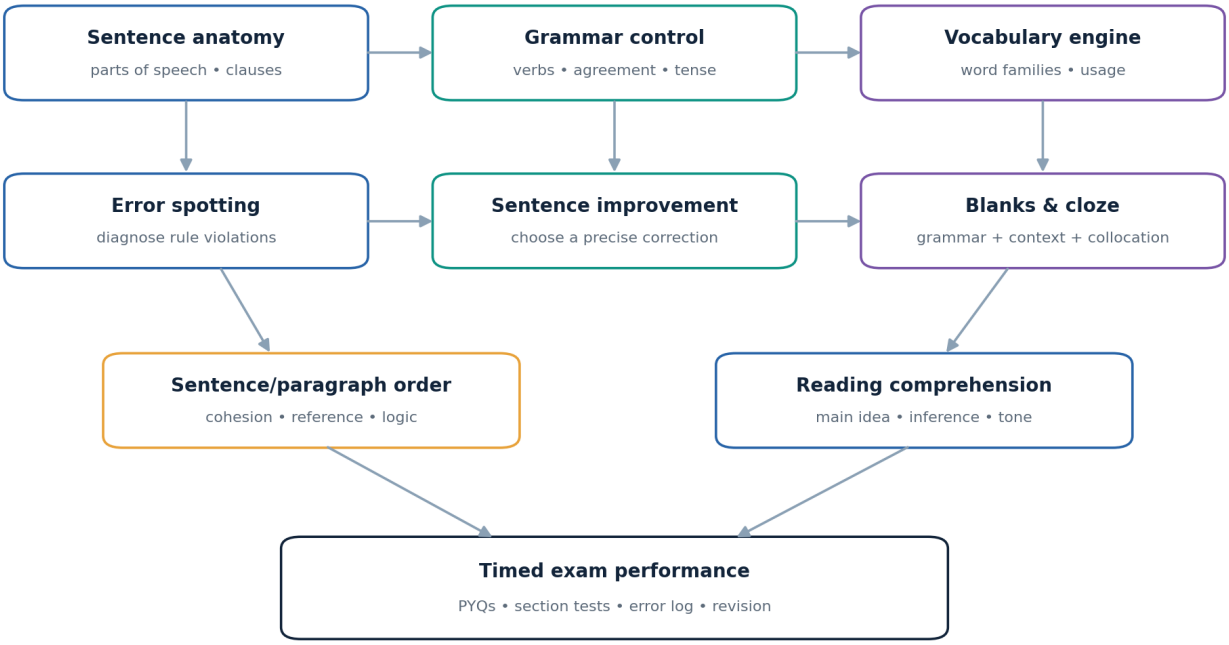


Study-design recommendation, not predicted exam-question distribution. Daily vocabulary and error review can be integrated across categories.

Allocation is a recommended share of study time, not an expected question distribution.

4. The learning order: concepts that unlock other concepts

Learning dependency: build language control, then combine skills



The best order in plain English

1. Understand what each word is doing in a sentence: noun, pronoun, verb, modifier, connector and clause.
2. Learn how verbs agree with subjects, how tense works, and how articles, prepositions and conjunctions connect ideas.
3. Use those rules to identify errors, improve sentences and choose the right blank in context.
4. Build vocabulary through word families and context; connect words through collocations and idioms.
5. Practise reading, cloze and paragraph ordering; finish each week with mixed PYQs and a mistake review.

AVOID THE COMMON TRAP

Do not watch grammar videos for weeks without answering questions. After every concept, attempt a short no-notes set and then an authentic previous-year set.

5. Module A — Grammar engine (priority P0)

Grammar is not a list to memorise once. It is a diagnostic system: identify the sentence structure, locate the likely rule, test the options, and check that the full sentence remains grammatical and logical.

Chapter cluster	Checklist of concepts	Questions this supports
Sentence anatomy	Parts of speech; phrases and clauses; subject, verb, object, complement; sentence types	Error spotting, sentence improvement, comprehension
Nouns and pronouns	Count/non-count; number; possessives; pronoun case; agreement; relative pronouns	Errors, blanks, sentence correction
Articles and determiners	a/an/the; zero article; quantifiers; each/every; few/little; much/many	Fill blanks, errors, cloze
Verbs and tense	Finite/non-finite verbs; tense forms; sequence of tenses; auxiliaries; modals	Error spotting, sentence improvement, narration
Subject–verb agreement	Singular/plural; collective nouns; either/neither; each/every; intervening phrases	One of the most reusable grammar rule sets
Adjectives and adverbs	Comparison; adjective/adverb choice; position; degree; common misuse	Sentence improvement and usage
Prepositions and conjunctions	Time/place/movement; fixed combinations; paired conjunctions; clause linking	Blanks, idioms/preposition, cloze
Conditionals and clauses	If-clauses; relative clauses; reported statements; parallel structure; modifiers	Advanced error and sentence improvement
Gerunds, infinitives, participles	Verb patterns; after prepositions; purpose; participle phrases	Sentence correction and usage
Common grammar traps	Double negatives; redundancy; faulty comparison; misplaced modifiers; parallelism	High-value review from actual mistakes

P0 MASTERY TEST

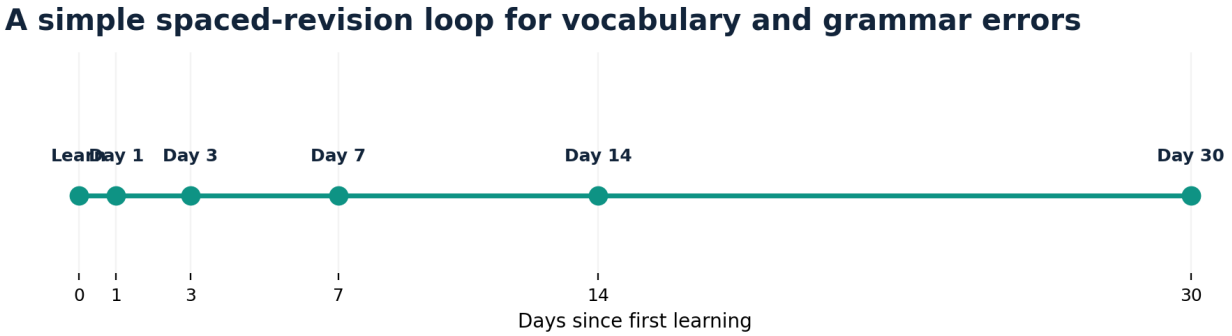
On a fresh 30-question grammar set, aim for at least 26 correct before calling the core stable. If errors cluster around one rule, practise that rule separately rather than replaying the whole course.

6. Module B — Vocabulary system (priority P1; daily)

The historical analysis makes vocabulary one of the strongest study-time investments. The winning method is not to cram a long list once; it is to revisit high-yield words, test recall, and learn each word in context.

Vocabulary family	What to learn	How to record it
Synonyms / antonyms	Meaning, intensity, part of speech and context-sensitive alternatives	Word; simple meaning; 2 synonyms; 1 antonym; one phrase or sentence
One-word substitution	People, habits, fields of study, speech, government, attitudes, specialists	Exact definition + word + a cue or example
Idioms and phrases	Meaning, standard usage and context; avoid literal interpretation	Idiom; concise meaning; sample sentence
Spelling	Frequently confused letter patterns, doubled consonants, silent letters, word families	Correct spelling + the mistaken form you chose
Homonyms and confusing pairs	Similar sound/spelling but different meaning or grammar	A/B contrast and one example for each
Collocations / phrasal verbs	Natural word partners and verb + particle combinations	Chunk as a whole, not a standalone translation
Prefixes, suffixes, roots	Common word parts that help infer new words	Root/affix + family members + exceptions

Spaced-revision loop



For each revision, retrieve the answer from memory before looking at the note. Mark words as: New → Learning → Recall stable → PYQ-confirmed. A word is not “learned” just because its meaning looks familiar.

Daily vocabulary target

- Start with 10–15 new words or phrases per day, depending on retention; 20 accurately retained words beat 60 forgotten ones.
- Review older words before learning new ones. Keep a separate list of words actually found in SSC PYQs.
- For spelling, write or type the word correctly and use it in a short phrase; do not depend only on visual recognition.

7. Module C — Sentence-level questions (priority P1)

Question type	Solve it through	Common mistake to avoid
Spot the Error	Read the sentence in chunks; check subject–verb, tense, pronoun, article, modifier, preposition, parallelism	Guessing based on what “sounds right” without identifying a rule
Sentence Improvement	Keep the original meaning; compare options; reject grammar, usage and redundancy problems	Selecting an option that fixes one word but breaks the full sentence
Fill in the Blanks	Identify part of speech; read neighbouring words; test grammar and meaning; check collocation	Using vocabulary alone when the blank is grammatical
Cloze Passage	Read for tone and argument; track reference words; use grammar, collocation and paragraph logic	Solving five blanks independently without understanding the passage
Synonym/antonym in context	Identify the exact sense and part of speech in context before comparing options	Choosing a dictionary synonym that does not fit the sentence
Spelling / mis-spelt words	Check known spelling families and compare all options carefully	Overlooking the correct spelling because another option looks familiar
Idioms and one-word substitution	Recall exact meaning; test that the option fits the sentence grammatically	Choosing an approximate meaning rather than the precise standard sense

Cloze: a repeatable 5-step approach

6. Read the full passage once for topic and tone.
7. For each blank, decide whether it needs a noun, verb, modifier, connector or contextual word.
8. Test grammar and collocation together.
9. Re-read the complete sentence with the chosen word.
10. Read the full passage again and verify tense, logic and consistency.

PRACTICE RULE

After learning a question type, practise a small untimed set, then a timed set. When the same error returns in a second mock, add the underlying rule or word to the error log.

8. Module D — Reading comprehension and sentence arrangement

Reading comprehension

Skill	What to train	Proof of mastery
Main idea / title	Separate central claim from examples and details	State the passage in one sentence
Specific detail	Locate evidence; distinguish directly stated facts from inference	Find the exact sentence supporting the answer
Inference	Choose only what follows from the passage; avoid outside assumptions	Explain why the evidence entails the option
Tone / purpose	Identify attitude, purpose and rhetorical function	Use word choice and contrast as evidence
Contextual vocabulary	Use the sentence and paragraph, not memory alone	Explain why nearby context supports the meaning
Multiple-paragraph reading	Track purpose and link between a story, report, editorial or current-affairs passage	Summarise each paragraph and their relationship

Tier-II official detail: the 2026 notice specifies three or more comprehension paragraphs; at least one should be a simple passage based on a book or story, and the other two should be on current affairs based on a report or editorial. Build practice for that description, while remaining ready for variation in question style.

Sentence and paragraph arrangement

- Find the opening sentence: introduce the subject without relying on an earlier pronoun or connector.
- Find fixed pairs: cause → effect, question → answer, claim → evidence, problem → solution, time order.
- Track reference words: this, these, such, they, however, therefore, first, finally.
- Do not force an order based only on a single connector; validate the whole paragraph after arranging it.

A short reading routine

- Read one short story/editorial/report passage every day; summarise it in 2–3 sentences.
- Answer 5–10 questions, then mark each error as evidence, inference, vocabulary, tone or speed.
- Once per week, attempt a passage set under time limits and review why every distractor is wrong.

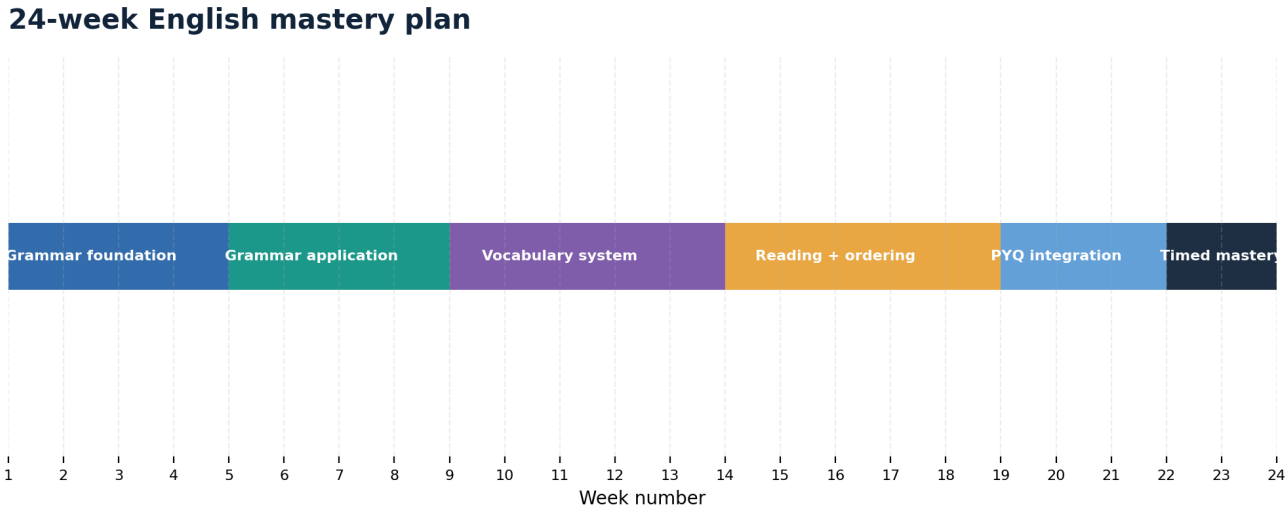
9. Module E — Voice, narration and transformation (priority P2)

Topic	Concept checklist	Practice protocol
Active / passive voice	Object promotion; correct be + past participle; tense preservation; pronouns; modal verbs; agent omission where appropriate	Convert both ways and confirm the original tense and meaning remain intact.
Direct / indirect narration	Reporting verbs; tense backshift where needed; pronoun/reference change; time/place words; questions, commands and requests	Group by sentence type; write a small conversion table before attempting mixed questions.
Sentence-part shuffling	Identify grammatical fragments; subject–verb unit; modifiers; clause relationship	Join fragments only after identifying the main clause.
Sentence rearrangement / para-jumbles	Topic sentence; reference chains; contrast/cause/time links; conclusion	Use pairwise links, then check overall coherence.
Sentence structure	Simple/compound/complex; parallelism; clauses; modifier placement	Use the shortest grammatically correct option that preserves the meaning.

TIER-I VS TIER-II

The same concepts matter in both stages. Tier-I demands quick identification under a 15-minute English timer; Tier-II gives 40 minutes for 45 questions but increases the penalty to one mark per wrong answer. Train for accuracy before speed.

10. The 24-week roadmap — grammar first, then integration



Suggested sequencing. Keep vocabulary revision, reading and PYQ practice active throughout every phase.

Weeks	Main topics	Weekly output
1–2	Diagnostic; sentence parts; nouns/pronouns; articles/determiners	Grammar baseline + personal error list
3–4	Verbs and tense; subject–verb agreement; auxiliaries/modals	Rule notes + two short mixed tests
5–6	Adjectives/adverbs; comparison; prepositions; conjunctions; clauses	Fresh error spotting and sentence-improvement practice
7–8	Non-finites; conditionals; modifiers; parallelism; grammar consolidation	One topic-wise PYQ set per major rule family
9–10	Spelling; synonyms/antonyms; common confusing words; collocations	Daily spaced-revision list; weekly word test
11–13	One-word substitution; idioms/phrases; word families; contextual vocabulary	Vocab notebook with weekly recall score

Continue daily vocabulary and short reading even during grammar-heavy weeks. The schedule specifies the main focus, not a reason to stop practising earlier topics.

11. The 24-week roadmap — reading, PYQs and exam readiness

Weeks	Main topics	Weekly output
14–15	Reading comprehension: main idea, details, inference, tone and purpose	4–6 fresh passages; evidence-based review
16–18	Cloze tests; paragraph logic; sentence-part shuffling; para-jumbles	Mixed passage sets and arrangement drills
19–20	Topic-wise authentic PYQs across all syllabus families	Error log by rule, vocabulary family and passage skill
21	Timed Tier-I English sections: 25 questions / 15 minutes	Two section tests; compare speed and accuracy
22	Tier-II English practice: 45 questions / 40 minutes	One full English simulation; test question selection
23	Weak-area repair and mixed PYQs	Repair the three highest-frequency personal error types
24	Tier-I and Tier-II simulations; final revision	Stable recall, controlled guessing and mock review

Weekly rhythm

Day	Primary job	Suggested output
Mon–Thu	Learn / repair one subtopic + question practice	Concept notes and 20–40 questions each day
Fri	Mixed English questions	One timed set; include old topics
Sat	PYQ test or sectional mock	Score + topic-wise review
Sun	Spaced revision / light reading / catch-up	Vocabulary review and next-week priorities

12. A practical daily system (45 minutes)

Time	Task	How to do it
8 minutes	Vocabulary recall	Review old words first; add 10–15 new words/phrases only if recall remains strong.
12 minutes	Grammar micro-topic	Study one rule or fix one previously weak rule. Keep notes to one screen/page.
10 minutes	Topic/PYQ practice	Solve 10–15 questions without seeing the answer key.
10 minutes	Reading or cloze	Alternate passage comprehension and cloze practice.
5 minutes	Error log	Record why the answer was wrong, the rule/evidence and a prevention cue.

One weekly longer session (60–90 minutes)

- Complete one Tier-I 25-question English section using the 15-minute limit; use the remaining time to diagnose mistakes.
- Every 2–3 weeks, complete a Tier-II English simulation of 45 questions in 40 minutes.
- Do not spend all your time reading explanations. Re-solve missed questions after 1 day, 7 days and 21–30 days.

Error log taxonomy

Code	Meaning	Repair action
G — Grammar	Rule was not recognised or applied	Write the rule; solve 10 fresh examples
V — Vocabulary	Meaning/spelling/usage not retained	Add card with context; test on later days
C — Comprehension	Missed evidence, inference or tone	Quote exact passage evidence for each answer
S — Structure	Voice, narration, shuffling or paragraph logic	Show the transformation / reference chain
T — Time / attention	Rushed, misread or over-invested time	Use a pacing rule and reattempt in a timed set

13. Mastery gates: move on only when performance proves it

Stage	Threshold to aim for	Next action if missed
Concept stable	At least 85–90% on a fresh untimed topic set	Revisit the exact rule; change the explanation source only if necessary
Mixed-topic stable	At least 85% on a mixed set without chapter labels	Tag errors by cause and schedule reattempts
Tier-I ready	Stretch target: 23–25 correct out of 25 within 15 minutes	Reduce slow decisions and review high-frequency vocabulary / grammar errors
Tier-II ready	Stretch target: 40+ correct out of 45 within 40 minutes with disciplined accuracy	Analyse negative marks; avoid speculative guessing

THE TARGET IS NOT A PROMISE

These are training benchmarks for a highly competitive score, not guaranteed cut-offs, rank predictions or official SSC norms. Your real target should adapt to mock data and the requirements of the recruitment cycle.

Section strategy

11. Start with fast, certain questions: direct vocabulary, spelling or rules you recognise quickly.
12. Solve grammar and sentence-improvement items by rule, not by intuition alone.
13. Treat cloze and reading as passage-based tasks: understand the context before committing to a blank or inference.
14. In Tier-II, account for the higher one-mark penalty. Return only to uncertain questions when time and evidence justify it.
15. After each mock, rank weaknesses by marks lost and repeat rate, not just by how difficult a question felt.

14. Small, consistent resource stack

The best resource plan is not the longest one. Use one main grammar course, one vocabulary revision system, one authentic PYQ bank and the official notification. Add a second teacher or book only to resolve a genuine weakness.

Free video / course resources

Rani Ma'am English grammar playlist — grammar-focused course shared by candidates and resource aggregators: https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLM9OY0jASMM368wfi4GU6Mq9miATnDEo8

SSC CGL English roadmap / free playlist overview (2026): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZsEGwfEFp30

SSC Ace curated English playlist and practice resources: https://sscace.in/blogs/best-ssc-cgl-playlist-and-books

Previous-year questions and practice

Comperly Acad: 2019–2025 tagged-topic historical analysis: https://acad.comperly.com/insights/ssc-cgl-topic-wise-weightage

PYQ Vault: cloze-test previous-year questions with answer explanations: https://www.pyqvault.com/questions/ssc-cgl/english/cloze-test

Vocab24: SSC CGL English previous-year questions for 2025: https://vocab24.com/ssc-cgl/english/previous-year-questions/2025

UnlockIAS: previous-year question archive (2016–2023 index; verify answer status per item): https://www.unlockias.in/ssc-cgl-previous-year-questions/archive

Official SSC website / notification: https://ssc.gov.in/

Book strategy

- Use one established SSC grammar reference (for example, Neetu Singh, English for General Competitions, Vol. 1) for rule clarification and exercises. Check the edition against the current syllabus.
- Use previous-year questions as the main test of exam relevance; use a concise vocabulary book or notebook for repeated recall, not as a substitute for reading context.
- For any resource, verify that a question is actually from an SSC paper before labelling it a PYQ. Coaching-made questions should be marked as practice questions.

15. Reusable mastery tracker

Tick a row only after finishing the concept, solving fresh questions and reviewing the errors. “Watched the lesson” is not completion.

Topic	Learned	Practised	PYQs	Revised
Sentence anatomy / parts of speech	☐	☐	☐	☐
Nouns, pronouns, articles and determiners	☐	☐	☐	☐
Verbs, tenses and subject–verb agreement	☐	☐	☐	☐
Adjectives, adverbs, modifiers and comparison	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prepositions, conjunctions and clauses	☐	☐	☐	☐
Non-finites, conditionals and parallelism	☐	☐	☐	☐
Error spotting / sentence improvement	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fill in the blanks / collocations	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cloze tests	☐	☐	☐	☐
Synonyms / antonyms / homonyms	☐	☐	☐	☐
One-word substitution	☐	☐	☐	☐
Idioms / phrases / phrasal verbs	☐	☐	☐	☐
Spelling / confusing words	☐	☐	☐	☐
Active / passive voice	☐	☐	☐	☐
Direct / indirect narration	☐	☐	☐	☐
Sentence parts and para-jumbles	☐	☐	☐	☐
Reading comprehension: evidence and inference	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tier-I timed English section	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tier-II English simulation	☐	☐	☐	☐

Reference and accuracy notes

- Official baseline: SSC CGL 2026 Notice of Examination, Tier-I scheme and Tier-II Paper-I English syllabus (section 13.11.3; pages around 25 and 32–33).
- Historical data: Comperly Acad, “SSC CGL Topic-Wise Weightage: What 204 Real Papers From 2019–2025 Show,” published 6 September 2026; 5,101 tagged English questions. This is a third-party categorisation and not an SSC-issued topic-weightage document.
- Resource links were reviewed for relevance on 30 October 2026. Course availability, playlists and exam rules can change; verify before relying on them.

FINAL OPERATING RULE

Learn a rule → practise it → solve real PYQs → record the mistake → revisit it later → test it under the clock. Repeat this loop until accuracy and speed are stable.